

Ines Said

Immersive artist and XR developer

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Washington, D.C. area and Tunisia · English, Arabic, French



I'm from Sidi Mahersi, Nabeul, a 15-minute walk from the ruins of Neapolis. I build immersive experiences about heritage, climate and energy: I founded Tanit XR, a volunteer community scanning Tunisia's endangered heritage in 3D (100+ free models, 85+ volunteers on four continents), and I'm the Lead XR Developer at Froliq, where my work has been shown at the Smithsonian and travels with Oracle, Exelon and Vistra.

Experience

- 2025 – Founder, Tanit XR**
Volunteer community scanning Tunisian heritage in 3D, one object at a time, with phones. Weekly community call, history lessons, the free Splats With Phones course, mentoring. Model being replicated in Nigeria with the Unique Mappers Network. Fiscally sponsored by Florida Community Innovation, a US 501(c)(3).
- 2023 – Lead XR Developer, Froliq**
I lead our AR and VR projects for energy, education and industry: Oracle Connected Hub (iPad, Quest 3, Vision Pro, Windows), NYPA Grid Experience on Apple Vision Pro, the Vistra Energy Hazard Tour, nuclear plant reality capture, the NEF VR mini-games, Sustainaball, StEve and the Exelon STEM program.
- 2022 – 23 XR Developer, Froliq**
Future of Energy and Water for the Smithsonian FUTURES exhibition (with Oracle), 600,000+ visitors; VR energy-education games.
- 2023 Adjunct Lecturer, University of Florida**
Taught VR application development for Android and wearables.
- 2021 – 23 Software Engineer, University of Florida**
Covid Reflections (AR public art with mobile health clinics) and spARc (AR animation tool), Digital Worlds Institute.
- 2018 – 19 3D Virtualization Lab Intern, University of South Florida**
Artec scanners, drones, photogrammetry.

Education

- 2020 – 21 M.S. Digital Arts & Sciences**
University of Florida, MiDAS, Digital Worlds Institute.
- 2015 – 19 B.E. Computer Science**
University of South Florida. Exchange at Deakin University, Australia (2017).

Awards and recognition

- 2026 Auggie Awards finalist, Best Societal Impact**
Augmented World Expo, for Tanit XR.
- 2025 EE 30 Under 30, Class of 2025**
North American Association for Environmental Education (NAAEE).
- 2023 Best Paper Award, IEEE ISEC 2023**
Developing Mini VR Game Engines as an Engaging Learning Method (with A. Barmpoutis and W. Guo).
- Excellence Award, GFAA Biennial**
For Shadows of Tomorrow, presented by Miami Chief Heat Officer Jane Gilbert and author Jeff Goodell.
- XR Prize Challenge, MVP finalist**
Augmented World Expo, for Shadows of Tomorrow.
- Hackathon wins**
Supported by Google and IBM through UF MiDAS; MIT Reality Hack.

Publications

2026

Digital documentation, XR and citizen science for community-led heritage preservation in Tunisia and beyond
Tanit XR. El Jem International Conference. Published in English, French and Tunisian Arabic.

2023

Immersive Climate Narratives: Using Extended Reality to Raise Climate Change Awareness
I. Said, A. J. Stanbury, E. Delhagen, H. Kang. ACM VRST.

2023

Developing Mini VR Game Engines as an Engaging Learning Method for Digital Arts and Sciences
A. Barmpoutis, W. Guo, I. Said. IEEE ISEC. Best Paper Award.

2022

Covid Reflections: AR in Public Health Communications
I. Said, A. J. Stanbury, E. Delhagen, A. Winger-Bearskin. ACM VRST.

2021

HoloKeys: Interactive Piano Education Using Augmented Reality and IoT
A. J. Stanbury, I. Said, H. J. Kang. ACM VRST. Cited 18 times.

2021

SpArc: A VR Animating Tool at Your Fingertips
B. Li, I. Said, L. Kirova, M. Blokhina, H. J. Kang. ACM VRST.

2021

Immersive learning with an AI-enhanced virtual standardized patient to improve dental students' communication
A. Gowthaman, L. Kirova, B. Li, P. Molen, I. Said, J. Smith, C. Sukotjo. ACHI 2021.

Exhibitions

2021 – 22

Smithsonian FUTURES, Washington, D.C.
Future of Energy and Water, with Froliq and Oracle. 600,000+ visitors.

2022

Covid Reflections on tour
Florida, California and Japan, with mobile health clinics. Covered by ABC, CBS and UF News.

HEAT, GFAA Biennial, Gainesville
Shadows of Tomorrow, three months in the gallery.

MIT Reality Hack, Parsons School of Design, Ringling College
Shadows of Tomorrow.

In the Machine, 4Most Gallery, Gainesville
With UF Digital Worlds faculty and alumni.

2025 – 26

XR Women Museum
Tanit XR objects in two exhibitions.

Talks and judging

2026

AWE USA, Long Beach
From Scans to XR: A Practical Pipeline for Cultural Heritage, with Margarita Johnson. Also spoke at AWE 2022.

2026

Energy Thought Summit, San Antonio
Main stage: photogrammetry for energy and heritage.

2026

El Jem International Conference, Tunisia
Presented Tanit XR at the El Jem Museum, a few steps from the amphitheater.

2026

Spatial Creator Spotlight; Voices of VR #1728
Full episode on Tanit XR; interview with Kent Bye at AWE.

Judge
Games for Change Awards and Student Challenge; EE 30 Under 30 Class of 2026 selection; Heavener International Case Competition 2025 (University of Florida); E4 Youth Showcase (Austin).

Hackathon tracks organized
Tunisian-heritage track at ImmerseGT 2026 (Georgia Tech); two tracks at CityCamp Gainesville Hack Day 2026.

Tools

Unity, Unity PolySpatial (visionOS), Meta Quest, Apple Vision Pro, mobile AR (ARKit, ARCore), WebXR, Three.js, Needle Engine, Blender, photogrammetry and Gaussian splats (Scaniverse, PortalCam, RealityCapture), C#, Python, JavaScript.